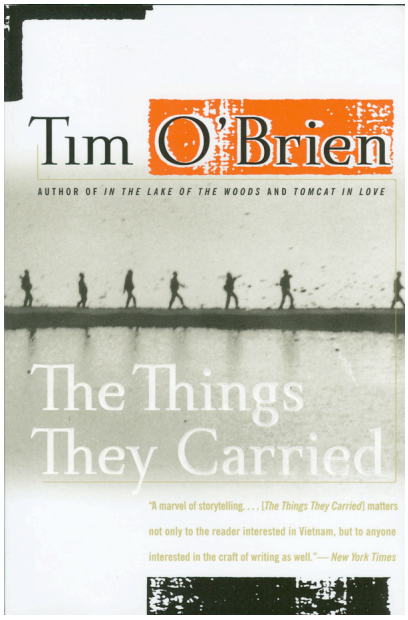
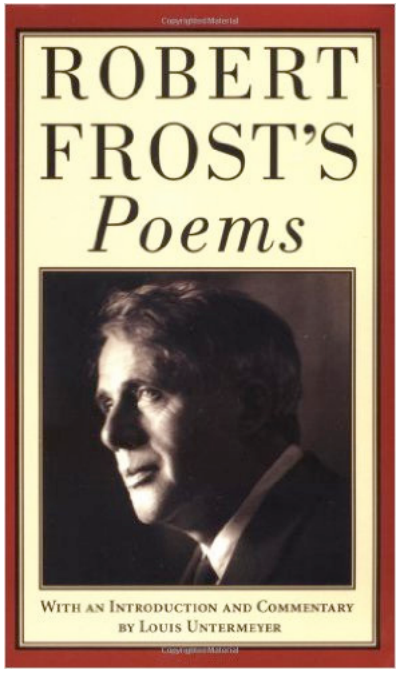
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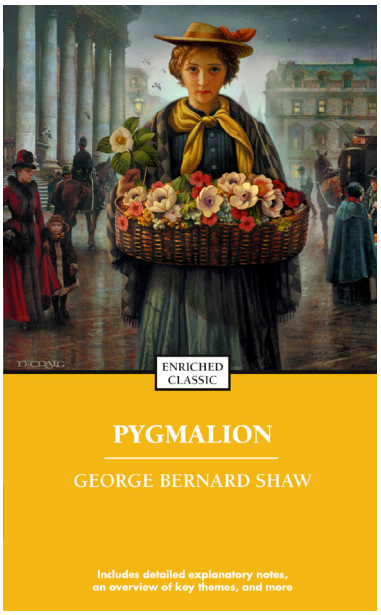
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# Literary Criticism

## Invitational A • 2016




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# University Interscholastic League
# Literary Criticism Contest • Invitational A • 2016

**Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History** **30 items (1 point each)**

1. A poem expressing grief, usually more intense and more personal than a renaissance complaint, is called a(n)
   A) aubade.
   B) elegy.
   C) lament.
   D) pastoral.
   E) serenade.

2. The age in English literature that witnessed the development of drama to its highest form is the
   A) Caroline Age.
   B) Elizabethan Age.
   C) Jacobean Age.
   D) Late Victorian Age.
   E) Restoration Age.

3. The genre of novel that places unusual emphasis on interior characterization and the motives, circumstances, and internal action that spring from, and develop, the novel's external action is the
   A) epistolary novel.
   B) novel of character.
   C) novel of sensibility.
   D) psychological novel.
   E) sociological novel.

4. The second half or resolution of a dramatic plot in which the failing fortunes of, for instance, the tragic hero are exhibited is called the
   A) exposition.
   B) falling action.
   C) moment of suspense.
   D) reversal.
   E) rising action.

5. The author of *Love's Labour's Lost*, *The Taming of the Shrew*, *Coriolanus*, *King John*, *The Two Gentlemen of Verona*, and *All's Well That Ends Well* is
   A) John Fletcher.
   B) Thomas Kyd.
   C) Christopher Marlowe.
   D) Thomas Middleton.
   E) William Shakespeare.

6. An interrogative statement propounded for its stylistic or oratorical effect and not requiring a reply or intended to induce a reply is a(n)
   A) dialectic.
   B) equivoque.
   C) objective correlative.
   D) rhetorical accent.
   E) rhetorical question.

7. **Not** one of the British literary groups of the twentieth century is (the)
   A) Bloomsbury Group.
   B) Fireside Poets.
   C) Language Poets.
   D) Martian School.
   E) The Movement.

8. Any comic book or graphic novel, originally Japanese, that, since the early 1950s, presents in book form a story of fantasy, science fiction, or romance represents the style known as
   A) anime.
   B) bunraku.
   C) kabuki.
   D) manga.
   E) senryu.

9. The system of manners and morals, which as a product of medieval feudalism, characterizes, in a highly idealized form, medieval romance is
   A) Byronism.
   B) chivalry.
   C) decadence.
   D) patronage.
   E) ratiocination.

10. The playwright whose *Our Town* and *The Skin of Our Teeth* earned him the Pulitzer Prize for Drama in both 1938 and 1943 is
    A) David Auburn.
    B) Horton Foote.
    C) Sidney Kingsley.
    D) John Patrick.
    E) Thornton Wilder.

11. The point at which the opposing forces that create the conflict interlock in the decisive action on which a plot will turn is called (a)

A) crisis.
B) *dénouement*.
C) fused rhyme.
D) peripety.
E) volta.

12. The honorary position that has, over the centuries, encompassed a wide range of duties, including the writing of verse in times of national stress or strong patriotic feeling and for special occasions, is the

A) minnesinger.
B) poet laureate.
C) poetaster.
D) putative author.
E) troubadour.

13. Words with the same or similar, though by convention not exact, meanings are

A) antonyms.
B) eponyms.
C) heteronyms.
D) homonyms.
E) synonyms.

14. The recipient of the Robert Frost lifetime achievement award as well as the 1950 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry for her collection of poems, *Annie Allen*, is

A) Rae Armantrout.
B) Gwendolyn Brooks.
C) Rita Dove.
D) Claudia Emerson.
E) Lisel Mueller.

15. The term that, in drama, refers to a particular kind of play as originally defined in Aristotle's *Poetics* and which recounts a causally related sequence of events in the life of a person of significance, culminating in an unhappy catastrophe, the whole treated with dignity and seriousness, is

A) chronicle play.
B) comedy.
C) melodrama.
D) tragedy.
E) tragicomedy.

16. The period of American literature in which Benjamin Franklin, Anne Bradstreet, and Jonathan Edwards flourished as authors is called the

A) Colonial Period.
B) Postmodern Period.
C) Realistic Period.
D) Revolutionary and Early National Period.
E) Romantic Period.

17. A central idea that in nonfiction prose is recognized as the general topic and in fiction, poetry, and drama is considered the abstract concept made concrete through representation is (the)

A) climax.
B) *in medias res*.
C) motif.
D) theme.
E) thesis.

18. **Not** one of Charles Dickens's nineteenth-century novels is

A) *Adam Bede*.
B) *David Copperfield*.
C) *Hard Times*.
D) *Oliver Twist*.
E) *The Pickwick Papers*.

19. The literary trope that can be used to heighten effect, including humorous effect, through exaggeration is

A) animism.
B) gigantism.
C) hyperbole.
D) litotes.
E) understatement.

20. The late-nineteenth-century, early twentieth-century English author of *Wee Willie Winkie and Other Child Stories, Just So Stories for Little Children*, *Captains Courageous*, "The Man Who Would Be King," and *Kim* who received the 1907 Nobel Prize for Literature is

A) Thomas Hardy.
B) James Joyce.
C) Rudyard Kipling.
D) D. H. Lawrence.
E) W. Somerset Maugham.

21. The word meaning 'rebirth' commonly applied to the period of transition from the medieval to the modern world in Western Europe is

A) boustrophedon.
B) jeremiad.
C) neoclassicism.
D) pastoral.
E) renaissance.

22. Heralded as "the father of American literature" but **not** a recipient of the Pulitzer Prize for Fiction for any of his fifteen-plus major works is

A) Stephen Vincent Benét.
B) Robert Olen Butler.
C) Samuel Langhorne Clemens.
D) N. Scott Momaday.
E) John Kennedy Toole.

23. The term originally used as a substitute for "popular antiquities" but now used to categorize the comparison and identification of the surviving evidence of archaic beliefs, customs, and traditions in modern ages is

A) folk ballad.
B) folk etymology.
C) folklore.
D) folk song.
E) folktale.

24. A term used, often narrowly, to suggest a certain complacency, hypocrisy, or squeamishness assumed to characterize the attitudes of the last half of the nineteenth century in Britain, all of which are apparent in the cautious manner with which writers treat such matters as profanity and sex, is

A) dandyism.
B) hedonism.
C) meliorism.
D) Puritanism.
E) Victorian.

25. A proverb or saying made familiar by long use, such as "a stitch in time saves nine," is a(n)

A) adage.
B) anecdote.
C) epigram.
D) limerick.
E) merism.

26. The continuation of the sense and grammatical construction of a line of verse from one stanza to the next stanza is called (a)

A) enjambment.
B) fused rhyme.
C) metaplasm.
D) run-on line.
E) tagline.

27. The recurrent grouping of two or more verse lines in terms of length, metrical form, and often rhyme schemes is known as a(n)

A) arabesque.
B) hemistich.
C) monostich.
D) stanza.
E) telestich.

28. The recipient of the 1924 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry for his *New Hampshire: A Poem with Notes and Grace Notes*, the 1931 Pulitzer for his *Collected Poems*, the 1937 Pulitzer for *A Further Range*, and the 1943 Pulitzer for his *A Witness Tree* is

A) John Berryman.
B) Alan Dugan.
C) Robert Frost.
D) Robert Lowell.
E) Mark Strand.

29. The twentieth-century Scottish recipient of the Most Excellent Order of the British Empire in 1993 whose novels include *Memento Mori*, *The Prime of Miss Jean Brodie*, *Loitering with Intent*, *A Far Cry from Kensington*, *Aiding and Abetting*, and *The Finishing School* is

A) Elizabeth Bowen.
B) Nadine Gordimer.
C) Doris Lessing.
D) Edna O'Brien.
E) Muriel Spark.

30. A novel in which actual persons are presented under the guise of fiction is known as a

A) *roman à clef*.
B) *roman à thèse*.
C) *roman de geste*.
D) *roman-fleuve*.
E) *roman noir*.

**Part 2: The UIL Reading List** **20 items (2 points each)**

**Items 31-36 are associated with George Bernard Shaw's *Pygmalion*.**

**Items 37-42 are associated with Tim O'Brien's *The Things They Carried*.**

**Items 43-50 are associated with Robert Frost's poetry (selected).**

31. The opening scene of the Irish playwright George Bernard Shaw's *Pygmalion* expects the audience to recognize the urban geography of

A) Dublin.
B) Edinburgh.
C) London.
D) New York.
E) Paris.

32. "There can be no question that as a matter of morals it's a positive crime to give this chap a farthing. And yet I feel a sort of rough justice in his claim" encapsulates

A) Colonel Pickering's understanding of Nepommuck.
B) Freddy's understanding of Nepommuck.
C) Mrs. Higgins's feelings for the cab driver.
D) Professor Higgins's regard for Mr. Doolittle.
E) Professor Higgins's thoughts on Ezra Wannafeller.

33. The author of *Spoken Sanscrit* who declares, "I am myself a student of Indian dialects" is

A) Alfred Doolittle.
B) Freddy Eynsford Hill.
C) Henry Higgins.
D) Colonel Pickering.
E) Ezra Wannafeller.

34. "It's all a matter of habit. Theres no right or wrong in it. Nobody means anything by it. And it's so quaint, and gives such a smart emphasis to things that are not in themselves very witty" is Clara's comment on the

A) custom of using the word *bloody*.
B) hailing of cabs with phonetically difficult words.
C) spelling of contractions without apostrophes.
D) throwing of slippers at professors.
E) wearing of flowers in one's lapel.

35. "What right have you to go to the police and give the girl's name as if she were a thief, or a lost umbrella, or something?" are words of reprimand delivered by

A) Mr. Doolittle.
B) Mrs. Higgins.
C) Professor Higgins.
D) Mrs. Pearce.
E) Colonel Pickering.

36. While Henry and his mother are arguing about Henry's contribution to the much improved Eliza, Eliza thanks Colonel Pickering for

A) buying her a ring in Brighton.
B) coming back from India to rescue her.
C) introducing her to a Hungarian linguist.
D) opening up a flower shop for her.
E) teaching her very fine manners.

37. In the opening "chapter" of Tim O'Brien's *The Things They Carried*, the narrator's observation that he and his fellow soldiers "were too frightened to be cowards" constitutes a(n)

A) conceit.
B) hyperbole.
C) paradox.
D) tautology.
E) understatement.

38. At age eighteen during the summer of 1968, the young O'Brien worked on a

A) boat on a river in Canada.
B) disassembly line.
C) golf course in his home town.
D) local newspaper.
E) short story about Viet Nam.

39. The comfort that O'Brien and his fellow soldiers experience in Bowker and Dobbins's "playing checkers every evening" stems from the simple fact that in the combat on the checkerboard

A) no one dies.
B) the large Dobbins does not automatically win.
C) there are no booby traps.
D) there are rules.
E) Viet Nam is forgotten for a moment.

40. Following Sanders's confessing that he had made up a few things in telling a war story, the narrator concludes, "A true war story, if truly told,

A) ensures a retelling."
B) ensures a sympathetic response."
C) fails miserably."
D) makes the audience cry."
E) makes the stomach believe."

41. Mary Anne's softly delivered avowal, "You're in a place where you don't belong" is addressed to

A) Mark Fossie.
B) Dave Jensen.
C) Bobby Jorgenson.
D) Curt Lemon.
E) Mitchell Sanders.

42. "In the field, though, the causes were immediate. A moment of carelessness or bad judgment or plain stupidity carried consequences that lasted forever" summarizes the narrator's reflections on the death of

A) Kiley.
B) Kiowa.
C) Lavender.
D) Lemon.
E) Strunk.

---

**Items 43-50 refer to Robert Frost's**

**Mowing**

There was never a sound beside the wood but one,
And that was my long scythe whispering to the ground.
What was it it whispered? I knew not well myself;
Perhaps it was something about the heat of the sun,
Something, perhaps, about the lack of sound—
And that was why it whispered and did not speak.
It was no dream of the gift of idle hours,
Or easy gold at the hand of fay or elf:
Anything more than the truth would have seemed too weak
To the earnest love that laid the swale in rows,
Not without feeble-pointed spikes of flowers
(Pale orchises), and scared a bright green snake.
The fact is the sweetest dream that labor knows.
My long scythe whispered and left the hay to make.

43. The form that Frost's "Mowing" most closely follows is the

A) caudate sonnet.
B) curtal sonnet.
C) English sonnet.
D) Italian sonnet.
E) Spenserian sonnet.

44. Line 11's "not without" is an example of

A) ambiguity.
B) hypallage.
C) hyperbole.
D) litotes.
E) zeugma.

45. Frost's sonnet relies on the melopoeic quality of

A) alliteration.
B) assonance.
C) consonance.
D) dissonance.
E) resonance.

46. The treatment of the scythe as something that can literally whisper is an example of

A) allegory.
B) apostrophe.
C) mythopoeia.
D) pathetic fallacy.
E) personification.

47. The punctuation that marks the end of line 8 suggests a continuation of both syntax and meaning from one stanza to the next and, thus, is an example of

A) enjambment.
B) hiatus.
C) inversion.
D) redaction.
E) truncation.

48. The poem's major theme is found in lines

A) 1-2.
B) 3-5.
C) 7-8.
D) 8-12.
E) 9-10.

49. Frost's sonnet is characterized by the marked repetition of sibilant sounds, which is known as

A) assonance.
B) consonance.
C) dissonance.
D) onomatopoeia.
E) sigmatism.

50. "Perhaps it was something about the heat of the sun, / Something, perhaps, about the lack of sound" (lines 4-5) features

A) asyndeton.
B) chiaroscuro.
C) chiasma.
D) sfumato.
E) synecdoche.

**Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism**
**15 items (2 points each)**

**Items 51-54 refer to Seamus Heaney's**

**Follower**

My father worked with a horse-plough,
His shoulders globed like a full sail strung
Between the shafts and the furrow.
The horse strained at his clicking tongue.

An expert. He would set the wing
And fit the bright steel-pointed sock.
The sod rolled over without breaking.
At the headrig, with a single pluck

Of reins, the sweating team turned round
And back into the land. His eye
Narrowed and angled at the ground,
Mapping the furrow exactly.

I stumbled in his hob-nailed wake,
Fell sometimes on the polished sod;
Sometimes he rode me on his back
Dipping and rising to his plod.

I wanted to grow up and plough,
To close one eye, stiffen my arm.
All I ever did was follow
In his broad shadow round the farm.

I was a nuisance, tripping, falling,
Yapping always. But today
It is my father who keeps stumbling
Behind me, and will not go away.

51. The imagery in Seamus Heaney's "Follower" includes
A) auditory and visual.
B) gustatory and olfactory.
C) tactile and gustatory.
D) tactile and olfactory.
E) visual and olfactory.

52. The rhyming of "horse-plough" with "furrow" (lines 1, 3), "sock" with "pluck" (lines 6, 8), "wake" with "back" (lines 13, 15), and "falling" with "stumbling" (lines 21, 23) constitutes
A) assonance.
B) consonance.
C) dissonance.
D) resonance.
E) sigmatism.

53. The continuing of grammar and meaning from the second stanza to the third is an example of (a/an)
A) boustrophedon.
B) elision.
C) end-stopped line.
D) enjambment.
E) tagline.

54. The strongest evidence of the narrator's remembering himself as being very young occurs in the
A) fifth stanza.
B) first stanza.
C) fourth stanza.
D) second stanza.
E) sixth stanza.

**Items 55-62 refer to Anne Bradstreet's**

**To My Dear and Loving Husband**

If ever two were one, then surely we.
If ever man were loved by wife, then thee;
If ever wife was happy in a man,
Compare with me ye women if you can.
I prize thy love more than whole mines of gold,
Or all the riches that the East doth hold.
My love is such that rivers cannot quench,
Nor ought but love from thee give recompense.
Thy love is such I can no way repay;
The heavens reward thee manifold, I pray.
Then while we live, in love let's so persever,
That when we live no more we may live ever.

55. The first three lines of Anne Bradstreet's "To My Dear and Loving Husband" exhibit
A) anadiplosis.
B) anaphora.
C) asyndeton.
D) echo.
E) epanalepsis.

56. The interestingly commonplace comparison of the abstract "his love" (line 5) to the crassly physical "mines of gold" and "all the riches [of] the East" (lines 5-6) should be recognized as (a)
A) metaphysical conceit.
B) metonymy.
C) synæsthesia.
D) synecdoche.
E) zeugma.

57. The comparison "I prize thy love more than whole mines of gold" (line 5) is (a)

A) double entendre.
B) euphemism.
C) litotes.
D) metaphor.
E) simile.

58. The meter dominating Bradstreet's poem is the

A) anapest.
B) dactyl.
C) iamb.
D) spondee.
E) trochee.

59. The major, ostensible subject of Bradstreet's "To My Dear and Loving Husband" is

A) connubial ecstasy.
B) familial wealth.
C) maternal instinct.
D) matrimonial love.
E) spiritual beauty.

**Items 63-65 refer to Thomas Hardy's**

**Transformations**

Portion of this yew*
Is a man my grandsire knew,
Bosomed here at its foot:
This branch may be his wife,
A ruddy** human life
Now turned to a green shoot.

These grasses must be made
Of her who often prayed,
Last century, for repose;
And the fair girl long ago
Whom I often tried to know
May be entering this rose.

So, they are not underground,
But as nerves and veins abound
In the growths of upper air,
And they feel the sun and rain,
And the energy again
That made them what they were!

*** a type of tree**
**** healthy (reddish)**

60. The rearrangement of words, as found in line 10, especially, to accommodate rhyme and rhythm, is

A) barbarism.
B) inversion.
C) metathesis.
D) parenthesis.
E) reversal.

61. Both the poem's opening line, "If ever two were one, then surely we," and its concluding line, "That when we live no more we may live ever," rely on

A) hyperbole.
B) litotes.
C) oxymoron.
D) paradox.
E) zeugma.

62. The poem consists of

A) alcaics.
B) blurbs.
C) couplets.
D) sestets.
E) tercets.

63. The setting in which the contemplative speaker of Hardy's "Transformations" is musing is (a/n)

A) Cade Yeager's ranch.
B) cemetery.
C) forest.
D) orchard.
E) prairie.

64. The logical form of the speaker's thoughts as expressed in the words *may* (line 4), *must*, (7), *may* (12) and, conclusively, *so* (13) suggests a(n)

A) analogy.
B) dialectic.
C) equivoque.
D) rhetorical question.
E) syllogism.

65. The subject of Hardy's poem is (the)

A) cycle of life.
B) death.
C) Garden of Eden.
D) remembrance of things past.
E) spiritual botany.

**The required Tie-Breaking Essay prompt is found on the next page.**

**Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay (required)**

**Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie. Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.**

Three sheets of paper have been provided; your written response should reflect the *Handbook*'s notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

---

Read Robert Frost's "The Figure in the Doorway," and discuss Frost's characterization of the man viewing those who are viewing him, with special attention to line 19, "Nor did he lack for common entertainment."

**The Figure in the Doorway**

The grade* surmounted, we were speeding high
Through level mountains nothing to the eye
But scrub oak, scrub oak and the lack of earth
That kept the oak from getting any girth.
But as through the monotony we ran,
We came to where there was a living man.
His great gaunt figure filled his cabin door,
And had he fallen inward on the floor,
He must have measured to the further wall.
But we who passed were not to see him fall.
The miles and miles he lived from anywhere
Were evidently something he could bear.
He stood unshaken, and if grim and gaunt,
It was not necessarily from want.
He had the oaks for heating and for light.
He had a hen, he had a pig, in sight.
He had a well, he had the rain to catch.
He had a ten by twenty garden patch.
Nor did he lack for common entertainment.
That I assume was what our passing train meant.
He could look at us in our diner eating,
And if so moved uncurl a hand in greeting.

**incline**

# ANSWER SHEET

## UIL Literary Criticism Invitational A • 2016

Items 1-30 **1** *point each*

1. ____
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Items 31-65 **2** *points each*

31. ____
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**Part 3**

_____
**contestant number**

_____
**SCORE**

***Please*** note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties. ***Simply adjust ranking***.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

**FIRST GRADER**

*number correct* x 1 _____

\+

*number correct* x 2 _____

= _____

_____
initials

**SECOND GRADER**

*number correct* x 1 _____

\+

*number correct* x 2 _____

= _____

_____
initials

**THIRD GRADER**

*number correct* x 1 _____

\+

*number correct* x 2 _____

= _____

_____
initials

**KEY**

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*line arrows up* ➔

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1. | C | 268 |
| 2. | B | 167 |
| 3. | D | 388 |
| 4. | B | 193 |
| 5. | E | |
| 6. | E | 412 |
| 7. | B | 200 |
| 8. | D | 285 |
| 9. | B | 85 |
| 10. | E | 67 |
| 11. | A | 114 |
| 12. | B | 369 |
| 13. | E | 470 |
| 14. | B | 604 |
| 15. | D | 480 |
| 16. | A | 96 |
| 17. | D | 476 |
| 18. | A | 562 |
| 19. | C | 242 |
| 20. | C | 599 |
| 21. | E | 405 |
| 22. | C | 604 |
| 23. | C | 203 |
| 24. | E | 496 |
| 25. | A | 6 |
| 26. | A | 174 |
| 27. | D | 454 |
| 28. | C | 604 |
| 29. | E | 591-94 |
| 30. | A | 418 |
| 31. | C | 11 |
| 32. | D | 57 |
| 33. | D | 23 |
| 34. | A | 79 |
| 35. | B | 109 |
| 36. | E | 118 |
| 37. | C | 21 |
| 38. | B | 40 |
| 39. | D | 31 |
| 40. | E | 74 |
| 41. | A | 106 |
| 42. | B | 170 |
| 43. | D | 260 |
| 44. | D | 275 |
| 45. | A | 13 |
| 46. | E | 361 |
| 47. | A | 174 |
| 48. | C | |
| 49. | E | |
| 50. | C | 84 |
| 51. | A | |
| 52. | B | 107 |
| 53. | D | 174 |
| 54. | C | |
| 55. | B | 24 |
| 56. | A | 296 |
| 57. | E | 445 |
| 58. | C | 244 |
| 59. | D | |
| 60. | B | 257 |
| 61. | D | 349 |
| 62. | C | 112 |
| 63. | B | |
| 64. | E | 466 |
| 65. | A | |

FOLD along the **three** longitudinal lines for ease in grading. ➔

***Please*** note that the objective scores should not be altered to reflect the breaking of any ties. ***Simply adjust ranking***.

The thirty items in Part 1 are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2 are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3 are worth two points each.

**DO NOT** mark (cross out) actual **LETTER** answer; mark the answer **NUMERAL**.

Page numbers refer to the *Handbook* 12e,

the Simon & Schuster *Pygmalion*,

the Mariner-Houghton *The Things They Carried*,

and to Untermeyer's Frost collection.

**Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay**

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

the degree to which the instructions have been followed,

the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,

the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and

the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

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**Critical Notes on Robert Frost's "The Figure in the Doorway"**

Literary concepts that MIGHT be used in a discussion of the speaker's characterization of both the "great gaunt figure" and "we who passed" him in Frost's "The Figure in the Doorway" include

alliteration,
anaphora,
characterization,
comparison (contrast),
couplet,
feminine rhyme,
iambic pentameter,
imagery,
irony,
litotes,
masculine rhyme,
repetition,
round character,
rhyme scheme,
rhythm,
theme, and
tone.

Robert Frost's "The Figure in the Doorway" is a fairly straightforward description of a recurring event (line 19 so implies), one that has given rise to a meditative reflection on what seems to be, in the final analysis, the superficial differences between someone in isolation and those who might, by virtue of traveling in company from one locus to another, consider themselves not bounded (or bound) by isolation.

The student should be able to draw—in summary—a description of the man in the doorway. The strong response, however, will note the round character developed through the speaker's observing the world beyond his doorway, being entertained by watching and, evidently, drawing his own conclusions about the lives of the people he sees framed by the windows of the train's passenger cars.

The young writer might recognize that the speaker is creating a vivid figure, one built on speculation—the train, no matter how many times it carries a passenger along the same track, offering but a glimpse of that figure in the doorway.

A stronger response to the essay prompt recognizes that much can be learned (perhaps ironically) about those on the train viewing the man in the doorway through the description of the man in the doorway himself. (Recall Faulkner's "Rose for Emily" and Chaucer's *General Prologue*, wherein we learn quite a bit about the narrators themselves through their descriptions of other characters).